



United Way Final Presentation



180Degrees
CONSULTING
— PURDUE —



Leonard Chiu
Project Manager



Olivia Pouloupoulos
Consultant



Arshia Ganesh
Consultant



Sanjith Santhil
Consultant



Aditi Ramkumar
Consultant

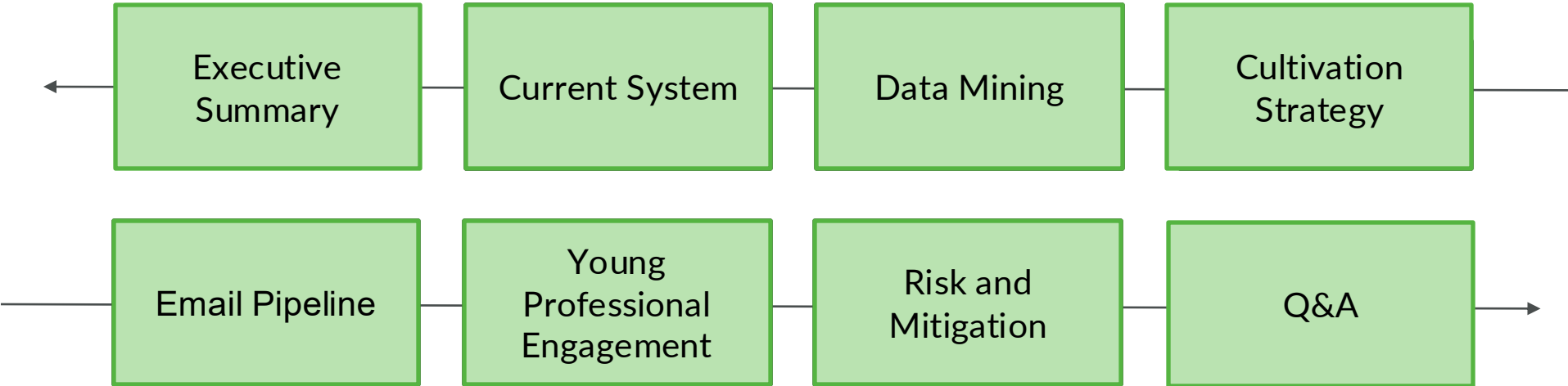


Srivalli Katkuri
Consultant



Hersh Parikh
Consultant

Meeting Agenda:



Executive Summary:

Problem:

Struggle with donor acquisition, missing structured conversion pipeline.

Solution:

Optimize existing systems, build structure email pipeline, strengthen community engagement

Barriers:

Limited digital outreach, weak donor data infrastructure, and low awareness of existing donor incentives



Current System:

Heavy Reliance on Workplace Donations

- Most donations come through employer payroll campaigns
- Limited direct relationships with donors

Declining Donor Base

- Previously had ~9,000 donors,
- Donors have decreased since COVID.



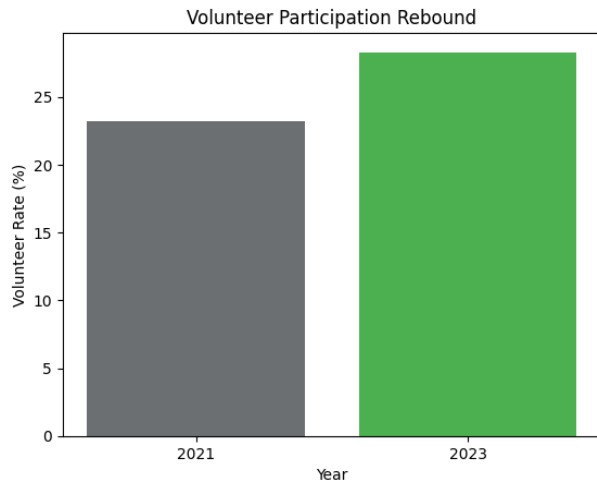
Volunteers Are the Natural Pipeline

- 70–85% of volunteers donate to the organizations they serve.

Conversion System Is Missing

- Currently no structured process to convert volunteers into first-time donors.

Current System: Structural Barriers Limiting Donor Growth



Volunteer participation has rebounded post-COVID and digital volunteering is growing (still minimal digital engagement)

01

Events Focus on Existing Supporters

02

Limited Digital Outreach

03

Limited Donor Data Infrastructure

04

No Defined Pipeline

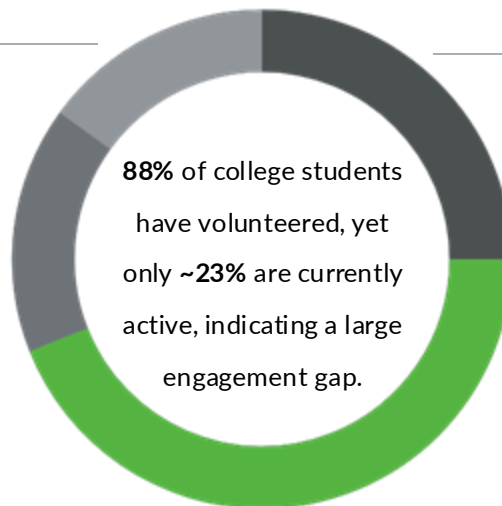
Current System: Young Professionals are a Donor Pipeline

Current Donor Base

- Average donor age $\approx$ 50
- Indicates reliance on older demographics

Volunteer Base

- Many volunteers are Purdue students or elderly community members
- Both groups have limited long-term engagement



Young Professional Target

- Goal: expand outreach to professionals in their 20s and 30s

Opportunity Gap

- Many young adults express interest in volunteering
- Lack of clear pathways for sustained engagement despite interest

Current System (Sign Ups)

What We Already Have:

- Internally maintained award-winning website for attendance
- Email Collection

Recommendation:

- Incorporate phone in addition to email
- Include availability (weekdays/weekends, range of timing)
- Include section for interest areas

Integration:

- Internally Maintained

Impact (Why Worth the Effort):

- Can cater according to demographic
- Informed Operations



Find Opportunities

Sign up and start volunteering today.

Create Account with Facebook

OR

First name

Last name

Email

Password [Show](#)

Confirm Password [Show](#)

Select Country [47907](#)

Create Account

Data Mining

Already Acquired

- Signing up for an activity = attendance based on website

What should be acquired

- What events have the most participation
- What volunteers are repeat volunteers at the same events



Cultivation Strategy

How It Works?

1. Introduce cultivation (friend-raising)
2. Identifying Clusters:
 - Segment volunteers by event participation for personalized outreach
3. Targeted emails:
 - “We’re hosting a small gathering for volunteers from [event]—join us”
 - “Connect with others who participated in [event]”

Why It Works?

Event Type	Typical Conversion	Why It Works
Traditional Task	10-15%	Focus on efficiency over interaction.
Community/ Social	30%	Focus on social ties and shared mission.
Hands-On Experience	Up to 50%	Emotional connection leads directly to action.

Cultivation Strategy

Outreach Method	Target Programs	Strategy
In-Person Invites	- Kindergarten Countdown Camp - Read To Succeed - Volunteer Engagement Center	- Invite on-site - Leverage existing momentum
Email Campaigns	Volunteer Income Tax Assistance	- Use digital outreach - Reach individual workers

Cultivation Events: Driving Attendance & Engagement

Pull Factors (Why people Attend)

- *Food*
 - Pizza, coffee, hot chocolate
- Games/Activities
 - Board games, icebreakers
- Themed Events
 - Trivia, seasonal socials
- Light incentives
 - Raffles/giveaways

Event Formats (How Engagement Happens)

- Bring-a-friend Social
 - Expands network
- Rotation Networking
 - 5-7 min conversation + prompts
- Veteran + New Mixer
 - Builds belonging + leadership

Key Insight

High attendance + structured interaction = real connections
➔ Stronger volunteer retention
➔ Higher likelihood of future donations

Continuation Analysis on Cultivation Strategy

Economic Rationale:

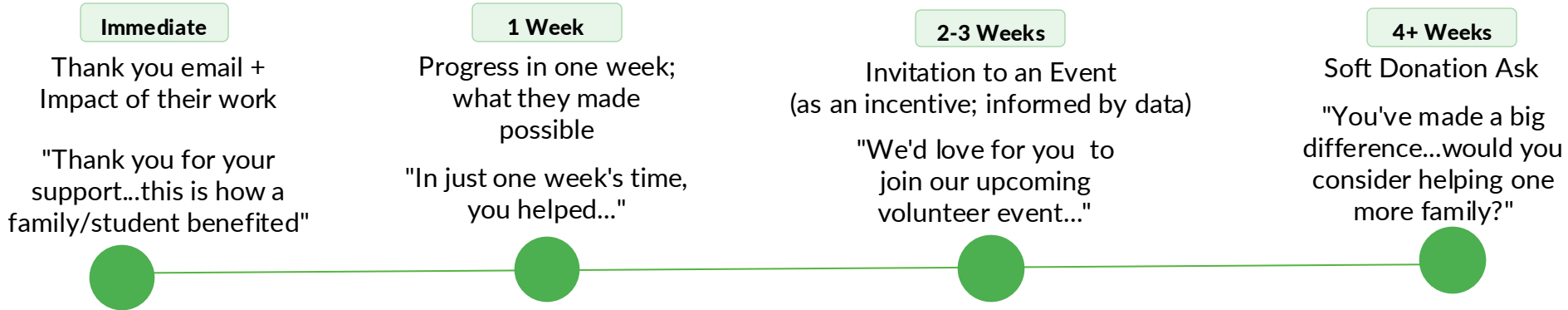
- Low Cost + High Impact (Ex. Board Game Night)
- Leverage existing spaces to keep overhead costs near zero

Performance Metrics:

Metric	Why it Matters
Attendance	Measures raw interest and reach
Repeat Rates	Measures volunteer retention
Donor Conversion	Tracks the % of attendees who eventually donate
Cost vs. Impact	Determines if the event justifies the resources spent

[More info on ROI](#)

Email Pipeline



Email Templates Stages 1 & 2

Stage 1 – Immediate

Purpose:

- Show thanks and acknowledgement
- Show specific outcome from their work
- No upfront ask for donation reduces pressure

Email Example:

- “Last week at [Event], you helped a student feel more prepared and confident. In just a few hours, you became part of something bigger than a single event.”

Stage 2 – 1 Week Later

Purpose:

- Share quick impact follow-up
- Reinforce how their time helped
- Keep United Way top of mind

Email Example:

- “In just one week, your time helped [X result]. We’ll continue sharing updates so you can see the impact you’re making.”

Email Templates Stages 3 & 4

Stage 3 – 2-3 Weeks Later

Purpose:

- Invite to low-pressure social event
- Focus on community
- Encourage continued engagement

Email Example:

- “We’re hosting a small get-together for volunteers from [Event]. Nothing formal, just a chance to meet others who care about the same things.”

Stage 2 – 4+ Weeks Later

Purpose:

- Introduce soft donation ask
- Tie directly to created impact
- Keep it optional to increase responses

Email Example:

- “Because of volunteers like you, [specific outcome]. If you’re open to it, even a small contribution helps us continue this work.”



Young Professional Engagement

Gaps

- Lack of Communication
- Email required to learn about different committees
- Missed motivation for resume building and networking opportunities



Recommendations

- Improve website
- List committees
- Mentorship Program
- "Volunteer of the Month"
- Current volunteer stories spotlighted
- Use LinkedIn, Instagram, and TikTok for outreach

Risk & Mitigation

1

Risk #1: Sign-Up System

- Excessive sign-up fields may deter volunteers from completing registration.

Mitigation

- Keep sign-up minimal, collecting deeper profile details and engagement preferences after trust is established.

2

Risk #2: Cultivation Events

- Volunteers who prefer solo participation may be alienated by an emphasis on group or community events.

Mitigation

- Support both individual and group participation through flexible outreach, phasing out formats that show consistently low engagement.

3

Risk #3: Email Pipeline

- Email outreach risks low engagement if messages feel repetitive, get filtered as spam, or miss volunteers who rarely check it.

Mitigation

- Lead emails with impact before any ask
- Delay donation appeals until the relationship matures
- Supplement with SMS or phone for volunteers less active on email.

Q&A

Appendix: Citation Detail -- Slides 9 & 15

Schlachter & Marshall (2024) -- U.S. Census Bureau / AmeriCorps Civic Engagement Report

What it measures: The Civic Engagement and Volunteering (CEV) survey covers 47,000+ Americans biennially across states and 12 metro areas, tracking both formal and informal volunteering rates.

Key finding (Slide 15): Volunteer rate fell from 30% (2019) to 23.2% (2021) and remained 1.7 pts below pre-pandemic levels as of 2023 -- confirming the post-COVID decline cited in our summary slide.

Key finding (Slide 9): Basis for our data utilization recommendation -- United Way can benchmark local engagement vs. national trends by correlating sign-up and attendance data over time.

Full Citation: Schlachter, L., & Marshall, T. (2024, November 21). New U.S. Census Bureau and AmeriCorps Research Tracks Virtual Volunteering for first time. Census.gov. <https://www.census.gov/library/stories/2024/11/civic-engagement-and-volunteerism.html>

Appendix: Citation Detail -- Slide 10 (Cultivation Strategy)

Greater Good Science Center (Feb. 2026)

Supports 'Why It Works' column:

Relationships form through consistency, positivity, and vulnerability. Traditional task-based volunteering skips these -- community and hands-on events bring them to the foreground.

'Community service' named as one of the Six Points of Connection -- directly validates United Way's event programming format (Slide 11).

Candid -- Beyond Fundraising (Jan. 2025)

Supports 76% volunteer-to-donor claim & Slide 16 social proof:

76% of volunteers donate to the same org (DoubleTheDonation data). Engaged volunteers become advocates -- the core logic of our pipeline.

88% of consumers trust word-of-mouth from friends/family -
- cited for spotlighting volunteer stories on LinkedIn, Instagram, and TikTok (Slide 16).

Sources: greatergood.berkeley.edu/article/item/how_volunteering_could_help_us_feel_connected_again | candid.org/blogs/community-building-strengthens-nonprofit-sustainability/

Appendix:

1. Grimm, R. T., Jr., Dietz, N., Corporation for National and Community Service, Office of Research and Policy Development, Child Trends, Michelsen, E., Zaff, J. F., Hair, E., Arey, K., & Foster-Bey, J. (2018). Good Intentions, Gap in Action: The Challenge of Translating Youth's High Interest in Doing Good into Civic Engagement. In Do Good Institute, University of Maryland, *Research Brief*. Do Good Institute, University of Maryland. https://dogood.umd.edu/sites/default/files/2019-07/Good%20Intentions%2C%20Gap%20in%20Action_Do%20Good%20Institute%20Research%20Brief.pdf
2. Wang, G. (2023, February 6). *The Ultimate Guide to Turning Nonprofit Volunteers into First-Time Donors*. The ultimate guide to turning nonprofit volunteers into first-time donors. <https://www.civicchamps.com/post/the-ultimate-guide-to-turning-nonprofit-volunteers-into-first-time-donors>
3. Schlachter, L., & Marshall, T. (2024, November 21). *New U.S. Census Bureau and Americorps Research Tracks Virtual Volunteering for first time*. Census.gov. <https://www.census.gov/library/stories/2024/11/civic-engagement-and-volunteerism.html>

Appendix:

https://greatergood.berkeley.edu/article/item/how_volunteering_could_help_us_feel_connected_again

<https://candid.org/blogs/community-building-strengthens-nonprofit-sustainability/>

Craver, R. (2025, June 13). *Donor trust 2025: The alarming data—and what fundraisers should do now*. The Agitator. [Donor Trust 2025 article](#)

Appendix: Citation Detail -- Slides 10, 12, 13 & 15

Wang, G. (2023) -- CivicChamps Guide

Slides 10, 12 & 15 -- Email pipeline & conversion:

Fidelity Charitable (2020): 1 in 3 millennials give more because they volunteer. The 3-step email template (thank you -> event invite -> soft ask) is drawn from this guide.

Key principle: conversion requires a deliberate bridge from service to solicitation -- there is no automatic pipeline without structure.

Grimm & Dietz (2018) -- Do Good Institute

Slide 13 -- Youth motivation vs. conversion gap:

Youth desire to do good at a 51-year high -- yet volunteerism remained stagnant for a decade. Confirms the gap between interest and action for young professionals.

Source: Do Good Institute, University of Maryland Research Brief (2018).

Wang: civicchamps.com/post/the-ultimate-guide-to-turning-nonprofit-volunteers-into-first-time-donors **Grimm & Dietz:** dogood.umd.edu/sites/default/files/2019-07/Good%20Intentions%2C%20Gap%20in%20Action_Do%20Good%20Institute%20Research%20Brief.pdf

Appendix: Complete Source-to-Slide Reference

SLIDE(S)	SOURCE	KEY DATA / PURPOSE
9 & 15	Schlachter & Marshall (2024)	CEV surveys 47,000+ Americans biennially; volunteer rate 30% (2019) -> 23.2% (2021), still 1.7 pts below pre-pandemic in 2023
10	GGSC (Feb. 2026)	Relationships require consistency, positivity, vulnerability -- volunteering creates all three; validates event-based programming format
10 & 16	Candid (Jan. 2025)	76% of volunteers donate to same org; 88% of consumers trust word-of-mouth from friends/family
10 & 12	Wang, G. (Feb. 2023)	3-step email template; 1 in 3 millennials give more because they volunteer (Fidelity Charitable 2020)
13	Grimm & Dietz (2018)	Desire to do good at 51-year high; volunteerism stagnant for a decade -- confirms youth interest-to-action gap
All	Craver (2025) -- The Agitator	⚠ Donor trust context -- subscriber-only blog, not publicly retrievable. Verify with client access before citing directly.

Note: Craver (2025) is from a subscriber-based blog (The Agitator) and is not publicly retrievable. All other sources above are publicly accessible and fully verifiable.

Risk & Mitigation

Key Risks and Mitigation Strategies for the Volunteer-to-Donor Pipeline

1

Risk #1: Sign-Up System

Asking for too much information at sign-up may cause volunteers to abandon the form

Data privacy concerns may reduce willingness to share personal details shorten this bullet point into one line

Mitigation

Ask only the most relevant questions at sign-up

Collect additional details (demographics, professional background) after sign-up once trust is built

Include questions like "How would you like to stay involved?" to guide next steps

2

Risk #2: Cultivation Events

Some volunteers prefer to participate individually rather than in group settings

A heavy focus on community events could drive away certain volunteer segments

Mitigation

Use digital outreach to accommodate individual volunteers

Balance group-focused events with options for solo participation

If engagement data shows low group uptake, phase out underperforming formats

3

Risk #3: Email Pipeline

Emails may feel repetitive or get filtered to junk/spam

Older volunteers may not actively check or use email

Mitigation

Structure emails to lead with an incentive or impact story before any ask

Save the soft donation ask for later in the sequence once relationship is warmer

Supplement email with SMS or phone outreach for non-digital volunteers

Appendix:

Calculating RoI

Develop budgets that accurately reflect investment in volunteer events



Typical Event Budget

Includes only cash revenues and direct costs

Revenue Generated	Cash Expenses
Sponsorships Participation Fees Direct Donations	Facility Costs Equipment Rental Event Supplies/Materials Marketing Materials/T-Shirts Other Printing/Postage



Complete Event Budget

Includes all resources

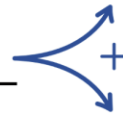
Revenue Generated	Cash Expenses
Sponsorships Participation Fees Direct Donations In-Kind Donations Volunteer Time	Facility Costs Equipment Rental Event Supplies/Materials Marketing Materials/T-Shirts Other Printing/Postage Staff Time

Calculating RoE

Ensure that volunteer programs deliver both revenue and impact

Eliminate activities with low RoI and RoE (< 200%)

$$\frac{\text{Total Value Generated}}{\text{Total Staff + Volunteer Hours}}$$



Total Revenue Generated Per Hour

- Increase total revenue or diversity of revenue sources

Total Impact Generated Per Hour

- Deliver mission-driven community impact (based on impact goals)
- Engage new donors or increase donor retention/level of commitment
- Strengthen collaboration with community partners
- Enhance staff and board engagement
- Increase organizational knowledge, skills, and connections

[Back to Slides](#)

Appendix:

KPIs for Volunteer Management



Ensure that technology and systems support movement along the volunteer-to-donor journey

KPIs for Cultivation and Stewardship

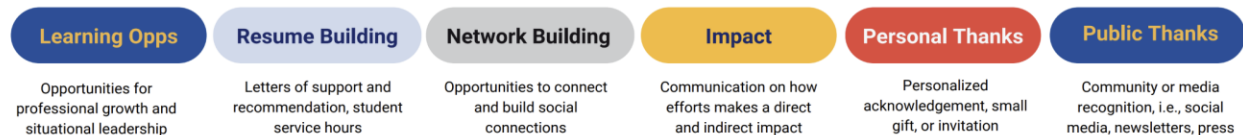
- Volunteers have opportunities to volunteer throughout the year and are actively invited to do so
- Volunteers have an opportunity to provide services aligned with their skills, interests, and level of affinity
- Potential barriers to volunteering are identified and mitigated for each opportunity type
- Volunteers receive an orientation to the organization and its mission
- Volunteers have clear expectations for their roles
- Volunteers receive appropriate training, supervision and feedback
- Organization has an active and updated CRM/donor database
- Organization has an active and updated volunteer management system tied to CRM
- Group volunteers have opportunity to provide their individual information at time of service
- Volunteers have an opportunity to make a (friction-free) donation at the time of service
- Volunteers are provided an opportunity to sign up for email list or follow social media pages
- Volunteers have opportunities to increase their level of engagement with the organization
- Volunteers have an opportunity to share their stories, experiences, and photos/videos
- Volunteers receive thoughtful, personalized communication tailored to their engagement history throughout the year
- Volunteers receive feedback on their performance and impact in the community throughout the year
- Volunteers have an opportunity to provide feedback on the quality of volunteer experiences and make suggestions for improvement
- Volunteers indicate that the experience of volunteering with United Way is integral to who they are
- Volunteers are celebrated in the community in a visible way and recognized at a personal level, formally and informally
- The organization has a clear plan for addressing volunteer issues and policies for dismissal

Aligned marketing goals:

- Increase #/% of volunteers that volunteer multiple times throughout year or that take on volunteer leadership roles
- Increase #/% of volunteers that step up to the next stage of the donor commitment and engagement
- Increase volunteer satisfaction and affinity
- Increase #/% of volunteers that recommend United Way

Types of Recognition

Tied to Volunteer and Donor Motivations Related to Achievement, Affiliation, and Power/Influence



[Back to slides](#)

Appendix:

COMMITTEES

Looking to make an impact beyond direct service? Our volunteer committees play a vital role in advancing United Way's mission and strengthening our community.

Serve on the **Community Investment Committee (CIC)** to help review programs and guide funding decisions that drive measurable results. Join the **Volunteer Engagement Committee** to expand meaningful service opportunities across our region. Support fundraising and relationship-building through the **Campaign Cabinet**, or lend your expertise to our **Marketing** and **Finance** committees to help steward our brand and resources responsibly.

Your leadership, insight, and expertise can help ensure we're investing wisely, engaging deeply, and building a stronger future for everyone in our community.

CONTACT US

[Back to slide](#)

Appendix: Email Templates Stages 1 & 2

Stage 1 – Immediate

Hi [First Name],

Last week at [Event Name], you helped a student walk into school more prepared, and more confident, than they were before.

That's not something we take lightly.

In just a few hours, you contributed to something bigger than a single event, you became part of a support system that families rely on.

We'll share a quick update next week so you can see exactly what your time made possible.

Best Regards,
United Way Team

Stage 2 – 1 Week Later

Hey [First Name],

We're hosting a small get-together for people who volunteered at [Event Name].

Nothing formal, just a chance to meet others who care about the same things you do.

- Location: [Place]
- Time: [Time]
- Coffee + light food

A lot of people said they wished they could connect more after the event, this is exactly that.

Feel free to bring a friend.

Best Regards,
United Way Team

Appendix: Email Templates Stages 3 & 4

Stage 3 – 2-3 Weeks Later

Hi [First Name],

Over the past few weeks, you've already made a real difference.

Because of volunteers like you, [specific outcome examples (25 students received school supplies)].

If you're open to it, there's one more way to support:

Even a small contribution helps us continue programs like the one you were part of.

[Donate Button]

Either way, we're glad you're part of this.

Best Regards,
United Way Team

Stage 2 – 4+ Weeks Later

Hi [Name],

I'm reaching out from United Way as we expand partnerships with local organizations to support both employee engagement and community impact.

We've found that structured volunteer opportunities not only strengthen community presence, but also improve team engagement and retention. Our programs, ranging from education initiatives to tax assistance and community events, are designed to be easy for companies to plug into.

We can also provide impact tracking and participation insights, so teams can clearly see the value created.

I'd love to learn more about your current priorities and see if there's a natural fit here. Would you be open to a quick 15-minute conversation sometime next week?

Best Regards,
United Way Team